

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Do We Describe Smells?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 16

No.	Sentence
1	A long list of apparent smell descriptions may simply mean that something is _____.
2	Speakers often describe an odour by comparing it with _____, such as a rose.
3	Words such as *stinky* and *fragrant* do not identify a perfume's _____.
4	Taste words can create a _____ that different people can share.
5	Smell descriptions depend more on _____ and feelings than on objective facts.
6	Children in the UK may show _____ in smells and comment on them.
7	It is often _____ who stop children discussing unpleasant smells.
8	English has _____ for the particular qualities of odours themselves.

11 **What does the list of words for unpleasant smells illustrate?**

- A English can name every odour's exact qualities.
- B English speakers rarely notice unpleasant odours.
- C Many expressions may still communicate the same broad judgement.
- D Each expression identifies a different physical source.

12 **Why are a rose and rotten eggs used as examples?**

- A They show how speakers compare odours with familiar things.
- B They show that pleasant and unpleasant odours share one source.
- C They provide a fixed scale for measuring smell intensity.
- D They identify two words for the same odour quality.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What does the perfume example show about *stinky* and *fragrant*?**
- A They refer to perfumes made from different ingredients.
 - B They describe two stages in a perfume's development.
 - C They must agree when the perfume itself is unchanged.
 - D They can express opposing reactions to the same perfume.
- 14 **In the researcher's view, how do smell labels differ from colour terms?**
- A Smell labels are always longer than colour terms.
 - B Smell labels can depend less on an object's properties.
 - C Smell labels can be measured more easily than colours.
 - D Smell labels are learned before colour terms.
- 15 **What does the contrast with taste words suggest?**
- A People agree more readily on smell than taste descriptions.
 - B Taste words are useful only for unpleasant experiences.
 - C People may find it harder to agree on what smell words convey.
 - D Smell words have replaced common taste descriptions.
- 16 **What pattern did the researcher observe in everyday talk?**
- A People discuss what they see much more than what they smell.
 - B People discuss odours as often as sights and sounds.
 - C People avoid describing what they can see clearly.
 - D People talk mainly about smells they enjoy.
- 17 **What is a cautious inference from adults ending children's smell conversations?**
- A Children will lose the ability to detect odours.
 - B Such reactions may discourage later talk about smells.
 - C Parents are teaching a precise smell vocabulary.
 - D Unpleasant odours become less common with age.
- 18 **Why is *musty* presented as an example?**
- A It states whether a person enjoys an odour.
 - B It compares an odour with a different object.
 - C It proves all old books smell exactly alike.
 - D It describes a recognisable quality of an odour.